

ANTHROPIC

Build your first skill with Claude

A skillathon walkthrough, using a change impact assessment skill as the running example.

Skills

Connectors bring in your data. Skills are your SOPs.

An **organized collection of files** (instructions, executable code, assets) containing everything Claude needs for a specific task.

Fill knowledge gaps

Specialized methods Claude doesn't have out of the box.
e.g. chemical structures from images, instrument data to Allotrope

Codify your SOPs

How your organization does the work, the same way every time.
e.g. change impact assessments, Salesforce timecards

```
---
name: change-impact-assessment
description: Produce a cross-functional impact
assessment from a change notice, using the company
template. Use whenever someone shares a supplier
change, spec revision, regulatory update or
contract amendment, even if they never say
"impact assessment".
---

# Change impact assessment
1. Read the notice and the template
2. Rate each function, never guess
3. Validate, then write the .docx
```

Tip: the description is the main trigger. Make it a little pushy, because Claude tends to undertrigger.

What could you turn into a skill?

Messy data to analysis report

Raw exports and notes in, a structured analysis in your standard format out.

Daily brief

What you need to do today, pulled from your calendar, email and tasks through connectors.

Competitive intel analysis

Gather public information on competitors and compare it the same way every time.

Literature review

Search a source like PubMed, screen the results and summarize with citations.

Meeting notes to actions

Turn a transcript into decisions, owners and a draft follow-up.

Checklist review

Check a document against your checklist and flag what is missing.

A good first skill is something you do every week and could describe step by step.

How Claude invokes a skill

1 User message

The user sends a request.

“Veridian is moving CTK-201 drug substance to a new site. What does that mean for us?”

2 Claude decides

Claude reads each skill’s name and description and judges whether one fits.

The change impact description matches the request.

3 Load skill

Claude reads SKILL.md into its context window.

Instructions and tools load now. Bundled files load only if needed.

4 Execute

Claude follows the instructions to deliver.

A completed .docx report with a severity rating for each function.

A simple, one-step ask may not trigger a skill at all. Claude reaches for a skill when the task is multi-step or specialized and the description fits, so write descriptions for the real requests people make.

You don't need to know how to build a skill to build a skill

General	formats that my company likes to use. Claude should use this skill whenever asked ...	
Account	Anthropic	
Usage	mcp-builder	...
Capabilities	Guide for creating high-quality MCP (Model Context Protocol) servers that enable LLMs to interact with external services through well-designed tools. Use when...	☐
Connectors	Anthropic	
Claude Code	skill-creator	...
	Guide for creating effective skills. This skill should be used when users want to create a new skill (or update an existing skill) that extends Claude's capabilities wit...	☒
	Anthropic	
Desktop app	slack-gif-creator	...
General	Knowledge and utilities for creating animated GIFs optimized for Slack. Provides constraints, validation tools, and animation concepts. Use when users request...	☐
Extensions	Anthropic	
Developer	theme-factory	...
	Toolkit for styling artifacts with a theme. These artifacts can be slides, docs, reportings, HTML landing pages, etc. There are 10 pre-set themes with colors/fonts...	☐
	Anthropic	
	web-artifacts-builder	...
	Suite of tools for creating elaborate, multi-component claude.ai HTML artifacts using modern frontend web technologies (React, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui). Use for compl...	☐
	Anthropic	

Turn on skill-creator

Settings > Capabilities > Skills. This is also where you see your skills and switch them on or off.

Say what you want

Tell Claude you want to create a skill, and what it will do.

Answer the interview

Claude asks about triggers, inputs and outputs, edge cases and success criteria.

Already did the work? Turn it into a skill

The most realistic way to start is a conversation that already went well.

- 1 Work it out with Claude until the output is right.
- 2 Ask for a skill, in the same conversation.

PASTE THIS PROMPT TO CLAUDE

Turn what we just did into a skill called _____. Use the steps we followed, the output format we settled on, and the corrections I made. Ask me about anything unclear.

- 3 Confirm the draft and fill any gaps.

What skill-creator pulls from the conversation

The steps you took, in order

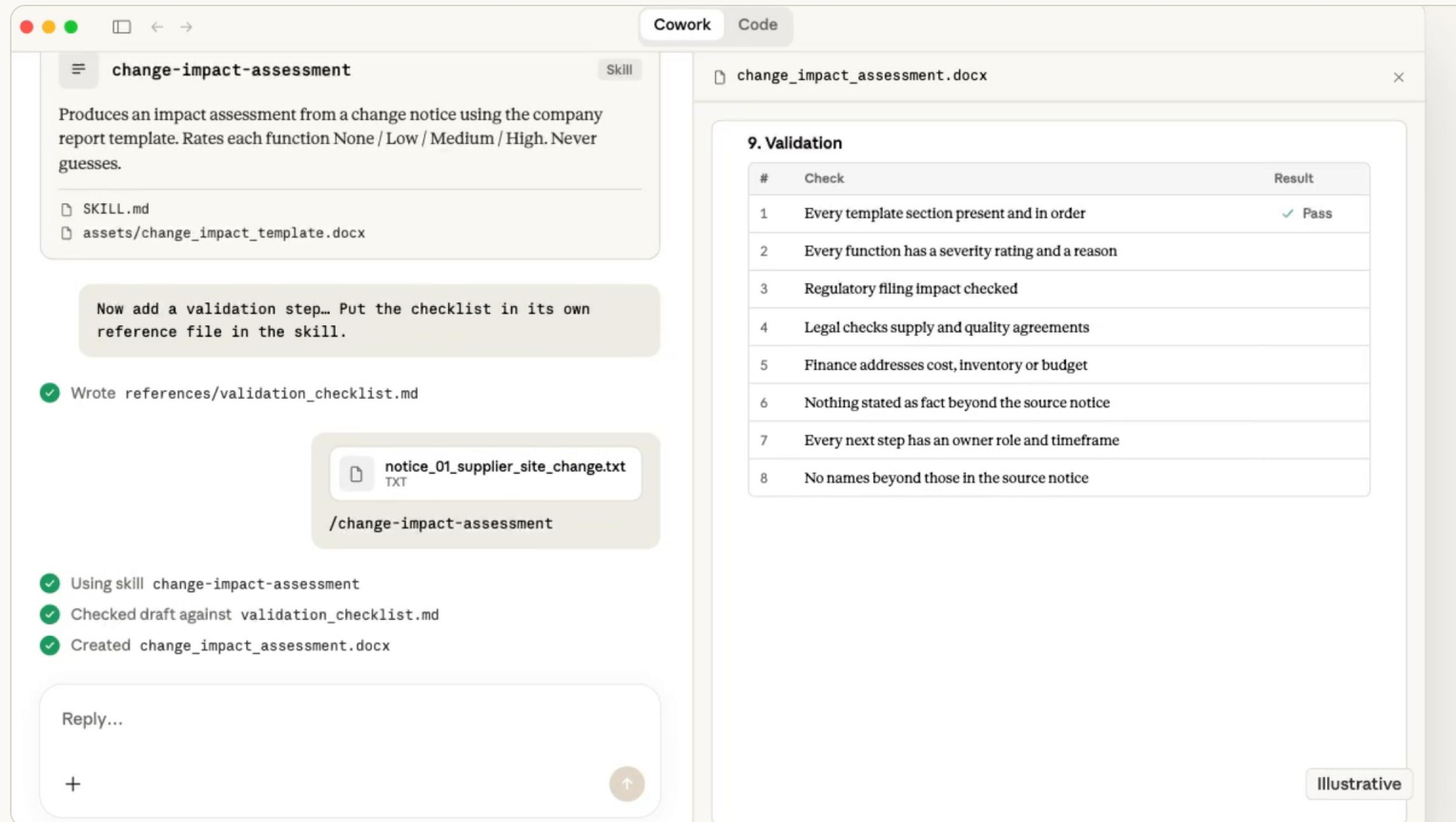
The tools and files you used

The corrections you made

The input and output formats

Tip: keep the version of the output you were happy with. It becomes your template.

See it in action



- 1 Attach your template
- 2 Answer its question
- 3 Add a validation checklist
- 4 Run it on a change notice

The clip is silent and loops while this slide is presented. Click it to pause.

The skill creation prompt template

TEMPLATE: FILL IN THE BLANKS

Build me a skill that ____.

PURPOSE

It should trigger when a user says _____. The goal is to _____ so that _____.

INPUTS & OUTPUTS

It takes in: _____ It produces: _____

TOOLS & DEPENDENCIES

It can use: _____

EDGE CASES

It should handle _____.

SUCCESS CRITERIA

A good result looks like _____.

FILLED IN FOR CHANGE IMPACT

Build me a skill called change-impact-assessment.

Triggers when someone shares a change notice, such as a supplier change or regulatory update. The goal is one consistent assessment, whoever runs it.

In: the notice and your report template (.docx). Out: a completed .docx with a severity rating for each function.

The report template and a validation checklist file. No connector is needed to start.

A vague notice: write “Insufficient information”, list open questions, never guess.

Sections in order, every function rated with a reason, owners by role and not by name.

Give skill-creator your template

Attach a document you already use. The skill copies its structure every time.

Without a template

Claude picks its own structure.

Every run can look different.

Reviewers relearn the format each time.

With a template

Section order, headings and tables are kept.

Your definitions come along.

Same shape every run, whoever runs it.

BRING WHATEVER YOUR TEAM ALREADY USES

Word document

HTML report

Slide deck

Spreadsheet

In this demo: a Word template with nine sections and a severity scale from None to High.

The prompt says: use the template exactly, keep the section order and headings, and output a completed .docx in the same format.

Add a validation checklist to your skill

Claude checks its own draft against it and fixes what fails before you see it.

PASTE THIS PROMPT TO CLAUDE

Check your draft against this list and fix anything that fails. Keep the list in its own reference file. Show pass or fail for each item in Section 9.

1. Every template section is present, in order.
2. Every function has a rating and a reason.
3. Site, supplier, process or spec changes are checked for filing impact, or listed as an open question.
4. Legal covers the supply agreement and the quality agreement.
5. Finance covers cost of goods, inventory or budget, or says there is none.
6. Facts come only from the notice. Inferences say "Assumption:".
7. Every next step has an owner role and a timeframe.
8. No names beyond those in the notice.

WHAT SECTION 9 OF THE REPORT LOOKS LIKE

PASS

1. Sections and order

All nine sections and Appendix A present

PASS

3. Filing impact

Checked for a site change

PASS

5. Finance

Cost, inventory and order minimums

PASS

6. Facts and inferences

Inferences labeled "Assumption:"

Four of eight checks shown, as an illustration.

Get started: two ways in

OPTION 1

Talk it through

/skill-creator

Invoke it, then tell Claude what you want to build. It asks follow-up questions and drafts the skill with you.

Works best when you have already done the work with Claude in the same conversation.

OPTION 2

Fill in the template

Build me a skill that ____.

PURPOSE

It should trigger when a user says ____.
The goal is to ____ so that ____.

INPUTS & OUTPUTS

It takes in: ____ It produces: ____

TOOLS & DEPENDENCIES

It can use: ____

EDGE CASES

It should handle ____.

SUCCESS CRITERIA

A good result looks like ____.

Either way, attach a template your team already uses so the skill copies its structure.

ANTHROPIC

Skillathon blitz talk template

Run a skillathon with your organization.

[Project name]

Team: [Team name] • [Member names]

What we built

One sentence on the solution: what it does and for whom.

Two or three concrete capabilities.

What it makes possible

What does it speed up? Compare how long this took before with how long it takes now.

What can you do now that you wouldn't have done before? What would you have missed?

Potential impact if scaled across your organization.

How we built it with Claude

[Screenshot or demo of
the skill]

What we learned

What worked surprisingly well out of the box? What was harder than expected, and how did you get past it? What would you do differently next time?

How did you test it?

What did your validation checklist catch? What would you check by hand that the skill should check for you?

What's next

With another hackathon day, what would you build? What skills, support or training would help your team use Claude well?

Appendix: build evals into your skill

Evals are test cases. Describe them in plain English and Claude writes and runs them.

PASTE THIS PROMPT TO CLAUDE

Create evals from the three attached change notices. Run each one and show me which checks pass.

Eval 1, supplier site change: Manufacturing & Quality rated High. Filing impact flagged. Quality agreement addressed under Legal. Minimum order increase addressed under Finance.

Eval 2, EU packaging rule: Finance mentions artwork cost and inventory write-off risk. R&D & Clinical rated Low or None. A next step is dated well before the 18-month deadline.

Eval 3, vague cleaning-agent email: No made-up details. At least two functions marked “Insufficient information”. At least three open questions.



Start with a known answer

Eval 1 has clear expected findings. It confirms the skill rates and flags what it should.



Test what it doesn't know

Eval 3 is a two-line email. The skill must ask questions, not invent details.



Re-run after every change

If a check fails, tell Claude what to fix, then run the evals again.

Four tiers of intelligence

Haiku

Haiku 4.5

Fast, cost-effective intelligence for quick answers, extraction and high-volume work.

Fastest, lowest cost

Sonnet

Sonnet 5

The everyday default for coding, writing, analysis and multi-step workflows.

Balanced speed and depth

Opus

Opus 5.5 · new

Deep reasoning for complex coding, knowledge work and long-running agents.

Deeper reasoning

Mythos class

Fable 5.1

Mythos 5.1

The frontier tier for the biggest, most critical work. Mythos 5.1 access is limited.

Most capable

Sonnet 5.5 and Haiku 5.5 are expected in the coming weeks. Versions change often; check the Claude models overview for what's current.

The Map of Claude · September 2026